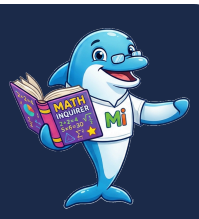
TUTOR NOTES • LEVEL 1 • TERM 1 • MI'S CHALLENGE QUEST

Mi's Challenge Quest



8 gates, one from each lesson of the term, all at Start here level, plus one optional secret cave item. 20 minutes after the break, played in pairs or as a group quest with Mi, working on private paper. It is a game: no score or mark is shown to the child, no ranking, no visible timer. You keep private notes only. For the tutor: do not hand these notes to families.

Where it sits. Lesson 10 (the last lesson of the term), minutes 63 to 83, after the break and the workbook; or at the make-up slot. Owner decisions of 22 Oct 2026: the end-of-term slot is a game with Mi, not a test. The group plays it in pairs (a child and a quest partner) or as a group quest with Mi, on private paper. No score or mark is shown to the child, there is no ranking and no visible timer. The tutor keeps private notes only, for one line to each grown-up and for advice for next term's group. It keeps the 20-minute slot after the break and the question quality: 8 short gates and one optional secret cave item, all at Start here level. Lessons 2 and 4 share gate 2 and Lessons 6 and 7 share gate 5, so every lesson of the term is still visited. A middle child needs about 16 minutes of reading aloud and quiet work; a slower child may use the 5 flex minutes at the end.

1. The gates at a glance

Gate	From	Area (tutor label)	What it uses (Start here level)	Answer
1	L1	Whole Numbers	Tens and ones: read a picture of sticks in tens and ones	**3 tens and 9 ones; 39 sticks**
2	L2	Whole Numbers	Number line (the number the arrow shows) and counting on in tens (Lessons 2 and 4)	**67; 44**
3	L3	Whole Numbers	Make the greatest number from two cards	**83**
4	L5	Addition and Subtraction	Add by making a ten, then with a tens number	**12; 42**
5	L6	Addition and Subtraction	Jump in tens (52 + 30) and take away tens and ones (74 - 31) (Lessons 6 and 7)	**82; 43**
6	L8	Addition and Subtraction	Equals as a balance: a box number	**6; 20**
7	L9	Length; Addition and Subtraction in context	Draw a line of a given length, then find a length 4 cm longer	**a line 6 cm long; 10 cm**
8	L10	Length; Addition and Subtraction in context	A two-step story, one operation per step	**35 + 10 = 45; 45 - 3 = 42 (Mei has 42 stickers)**
Secret cave	L10	Length; Addition and Subtraction in context	Reading trap: who is in the group (optional)	**9 children (5 + 3 + 1, counting Ali)**

The area labels are for the tutor only and never appear on a child or parent page. Each gate is a fresh example of the Start here idea of its lesson (numbers chosen so that they do not repeat a lesson page), so a child who followed the lesson can open it. Before first use, read each gate against what the lesson actually taught.

2. Playing it: before and during

1. A week before: send the grown-up note (L10_Quest_Parent_Note.pdf) and the Quest Log (L10_Quest_Log.pdf) with the lesson materials. Families print the Quest Log at 100%, keep it closed in an envelope and find a quest partner (a grown-up or a brother or sister). A family with no printer tells you: arrange another way (for example the make-up slot).
2. Tell the group in the opening and at slide s-quest1: this is Mi's Challenge Quest, a game with Mi. Everyone works on their own paper with a quest partner beside them. It is not a race, a gate may be skipped, and nothing is shown to the group.
3. Start at minute 63 (after the break and the workbook) and finish by minute 83. Children open the Quest Log only when you say. The paper lies flat on the table and is never held up. The quest partner may talk about how to start and ask 'how do you know?', but does not give answers. Cameras may be on or off. Use your own watch out of sight of the camera: no clock, countdown or timer is ever shown to the children.
4. Read each page aloud, one gate at a time, then leave quiet working time: about 2 minutes for page 1, 3 for page 2, 4 for page 3 and 3.5 for page 4. After each page say that the gates are open and Mi swims on, whatever the answers. Say nothing about right or wrong, and read no answers. A middle child needs about 16 minutes in all; a slower child may use the 5 flex minutes.
5. Allowed: fingers, counters, the kit squares, the ruler for gate 7, and talk with the quest partner. Not allowed: a calculator, a grown-up giving answers, looking at the workbook. A child who finishes early turns the Quest Log over and draws quietly. Colouring a

stone on the quest map means I had a go, never I got it right.

6. After page 2, take a one-minute stretch (stand, shake out, sip water). After page 4, show slide s-quest2. Do not collect or look at any Quest Log. A child still writing may use the flex minutes; nothing new is started there. While children work, notice (do not write on the shared screen) how they start: counters, drawing, number line, talking to the partner.

3. After the lesson: photos and your private notes

1. Same day: the grown-up takes ONE clear photo of each of the 4 pages (page flat, taken straight from above, the whole page in view including the 10 cm bar on page 4, and the name on each page) and sends them to the program's business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, and to no other number. Never to a child, never to a personal phone, never into the class chat.
2. Within 3 days: open the photos only on the business WhatsApp (never on a personal phone) and write your private notes (section 5) for each child, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Section 4 shows what each answer tells you. For gate 7, the ruler gate, hold the drawn line against the 10 cm bar on page 4: about 6 cm is what we hope to see. If the photo is not clear, ask the grown-up (not the child) for a clearer one, or rely on the answer to part (b). Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is added up and no order of children is made. Nothing about the quest goes back to the child or the group except thanks.
3. Write ONE line for each grown-up from your notes (section 7): what we saw, in plain words, and one small next step if it helps. It is sent to the parent only. No marks, no x out of 10, no ranking, no comparison with other children, no prediction.
4. Fill in the group advice sheet (section 6): what several children were still working on, with no names, and what you will do in the first lessons of next term. It is kept for next term's tutor and is never shown to families.
5. Once the line is sent, save the photos to the program's private file store and delete them from the business WhatsApp chat. The program keeps the photos for 90 days after the program ends, then deletes them, as the privacy notice says. Delete each child's notes sheet when the line is sent (keep only the line in the family file, and the group advice sheet). Never forward the photos or save them to a personal phone or any other device.
6. At the start of Term 2 say to the whole group: thank you for playing Mi's Challenge Quest; there is nothing to share and nothing to fear. Never name a child or an answer.

Privacy checklist

- Quest Logs are never held up to the camera and never read out.
- No answer is said aloud during or after the quest. Gates open for everyone, whatever the answers.
- No clock, countdown or timer is shown; nobody is told who finished first or last.
- Photos come to the program's business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962) only; tutors never use a personal phone; photos are kept 90 days after the program ends, then deleted; the line goes to the parent only; no private message to any child.
- No score, no x out of 10, no ranking, no tally, no comparison between children, not even in your own notes.
- The recording captures the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted: pause it for the whole quest. The WhatsApp number is never on a slide.

Absent, late joiners, families who prefer not to, upset children

- A child who was away or whose family prefers another time: plays the quest at the make-up slot BEFORE watching the recording (the quest is not on the recording, so no gate is given away). It is a small group or a pair with Mi, with a parent beside the child on camera. The tutor never sits alone with one child on a private call.
- A child who joined late: the family may choose to leave out gates for lessons the child did not attend. Write nothing for those gates; if no gate of an area was taught, the line for the grown-up says nothing about that area.
- A family that does not want the quest: no problem. The child does the Lesson 10 work as usual and the line for the grown-up uses your own notes from the lessons only.
- A child who is upset or stuck: remind the group (open session) that every gate can be skipped and Mi swims round it. Do not single the child out. The grown-up may stop the quest at any time.
- A family with no printer: tell the family to say so a week before and arrange another way (for example the make-up slot, with the Quest Log sent to the family another way). Never ask a child about it in front of the group.

4. Answers and what to look for

Use these to understand what you see on camera and in the photos. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is totalled and no gate is marked right or wrong in front of anyone. A child may write steps in any clear layout. Spelling and neatness do not matter.

Gate 1 (L1) Count the sticks. Fill in the blanks.
Answer: 3 tens and 9 ones; 39 sticks
(a) __ tens and __ ones = 3 tens and 9 ones; (b) There are __ sticks altogether. = 39
A secure answer looks like: 3, 9 and 39 all correct. **Half way there:** Two of the three correct (for example 39 but the tens and ones swapped).
Worked: 3 bundles of ten is 30, and 9 singles makes 39.
Watch for: 39 written as 93.; Counting each bundle as one stick (3 + 9 = 12).

Gate 2 (L2) Fill in the blanks.
Answer: 67; 44
(a) Look at the number line. The arrow is pointing to __. = 67; (b) Counting in 10s: 14, 24, 34, __ = 44
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: The arrow is just after 66 and just before 68, so it points to 67. In 10s: 14, 24, 34, 44 (the tens digit goes up by 1 and the ones digit stays 4).
Watch for: (a) 66 or 68 (the neighbour).; (b) 35 (counting in ones) or 54 (jumping twice).

Gate 3 (L3) Look at the two cards. Use both cards to make the greatest number you can.
Answer: 83
The greatest number is __. = 83
A secure answer looks like: 83. **Half way there:** 38 written (the other number made from the cards).
Worked: Two numbers can be made: 38 and 83. 83 has 8 tens and 38 has 3 tens, so 83 is the greatest.
Watch for: 38 (the smaller number).; 11 (adding the cards).

Gate 4 (L5) Look at the ten frames. Fill in the missing numbers.
Answer: 12; 42
(a) 7 + 5 = [ ] = 12; (b) 37 + 5 = [ ] = 42
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 7 + 3 = 10, and 2 more makes 12. 37 + 3 = 40, and 2 more makes 42.
Watch for: (b) 32 or 312 (joining digits or forgetting the tens).; (a) 11 or 13 from a counting slip.

Gate 5 (L6) Add or subtract.
Answer: 82; 43
(a) 52 + 30 = __ = 82; (b) 74 - 31 = __ = 43
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One correct.
Worked: (a) 3 tens more than 52 is 82. (b) 74 - 30 = 44, then 44 - 1 = 43.
Watch for: (a) 55 (adding 3 to the ones) or 522.; (b) 33 (taking away 41) or 44 (taking only the tens).

Gate 6 (L8) Fill in the missing number.
Answer: 6; 20
(a) 8 + 4 = 6 + [ ] = 6; (b) 60 + 10 = 50 + [ ] = 20
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One correct.
Worked: (a) 8 + 4 = 12, and 12 is 6 + 6, so the box is 6. (b) 60 + 10 = 70, and 70 is 50 + 20, so the box is 20. Both sides must have the same total.
Watch for: (a) 12 (writing the total of the left side).; (b) 70 (the total instead of the missing number).

Gate 7 (L9) Use your ruler.
Answer: a line 6 cm long; 10 cm
(a) Draw a line 6 cm long. Start at the dot. = A line from the dot, 6 cm long (5.7 to 6.3 cm); (b) A line 4 cm longer than your line is __ cm long. = 10
A secure answer looks like: The line is about 6 cm (5.7 to 6.3 cm; accept 5.5 to 6.5 cm if the photo is not clear) and 10 is written. **Half way there:** Only the line about right, or only the 10 written (a line within 0.5 cm of 6 cm counts if the photo is not clear).
Worked: Put the 0 mark of the ruler on the dot and draw to the 6 mark. A line 4 cm longer is 6 + 4 = 10 cm.
Watch for: Starting the line at 1 on the ruler (a 5 cm line).; (b) 4 (the extra only) or 6.

Gate 8 (L10) Mei has 35 stickers. Ali gives her 10 more stickers. Then she gives 3 stickers to Ben. Write one number sentence for each step. The last number you write is how many stickers Mei has now.

Answer: 35 + 10 = 45; 45 - 3 = 42 (Mei has 42 stickers)

(a) Step 1: .... = 35 + 10 = 45; (b) Step 2: .... = 45 - 3 = 42

A secure answer looks like: Both step sentences have the right operation and numbers (any clear layout) and the second ends with 42.

Half way there: One correct step sentence, or both sentences right with one slip in the arithmetic, or only the answer 42 without steps.

Worked: Step 1: she gets 10 more, so add: 35 + 10 = 45. Step 2: she gives 3 away, so take away: 45 - 3 = 42.

Watch for: 32 (taking the 10 away from 35 and adding 3 or similar).; 48 (adding both numbers).; Using 35 again in Step 2.

Secret cave (optional) (L10) Ali is in a line. There are 5 children in front of him and 3 children behind him. How many children are in the line?

Answer: 9 children (5 + 3 + 1, counting Ali)

There are __ children in the line. = 9

A secure answer looks like: The answer is as above. **Half way there:** -

Worked: 5 in front and 3 behind makes 8, and Ali is in the line as well: 8 + 1 = 9.

Watch for: 8 (leaving Ali out).

5. Tutor private notes (tutor only; one sheet per child; delete when the line is sent)

Child (first name only): ..... Date: ..... Quest partner: .....

Fill this in after the lesson, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Write what the child did and said in your own words. No ticks for right or wrong, no points, nothing added up. The gate numbers are only reminders of where to look.

Gate	From	What I saw (words used, counters or drawing, how the partner helped, anything the child said)
1	L1	
2	L2	
3	L3	
4	L5	
5	L6	
6	L8	
7	L9	
8	L10	
Cave	L10	

Prompt	My notes
Something the child did well (a named strength, for example: explained why 62 is greater than 26 using bundles of ten)	
How they started: counters, drawing, number line, or in their head	
Where they paused or turned to their partner, and what helped	
One next step for home (small and concrete)	
Did they try the secret cave? (a neutral note only)	

The one line for the grown-up (section 7), written from these notes:

.....

.....

6. Group advice for next term (tutor only; one sheet per class; no names)

When all the notes are written, look across them without names. Write what several children were still working on and how you will use the first two lessons of next term (a warm-up, a picture, a game). This page never goes to families.

Area	What several children were still working on (no names)	What I will do in the first two lessons of next term
Numbers, tens and ones Lessons 1 to 4: reading and writing numbers to 100 as tens and ones, number lines, comparing numbers and counting in tens		
Adding and taking away Lessons 5 to 8: adding by making a ten, jumping in tens, taking away tens and ones, and using = as a balance		
Measuring length and solving stories Lessons 9 to 10: drawing and reading lengths in centimetres with a ruler, and reading a story twice and writing one step at a time		

Prompt	My notes
Gates or ideas where several children paused (no names)	
A warm-up or game to bring back in the first lesson of next term	
What worked well about the quest as a game, to keep next time	

7. The one line for the grown-up: what we saw

Mi's Challenge Quest: [Name]
In Mi's Challenge Quest, [Name] [one specific thing you saw, in plain words]. [Optional: one small next step at home.]

One or two sentences at most. Say what the child did (used bundles, drew a line, explained a step), not how many answers were right. Use the lines below as patterns and always add your own detail from your notes.

Area (parent wording)	Things you might have seen (pick the one your notes show; add the detail)	A next step that helps at home
Numbers, tens and ones Lessons 1 to 4. We looked at reading and writing numbers to 100 as tens and ones, number lines, comparing numbers and counting in tens.	• [Name] read numbers as tens and ones using bundles and a number line, and made the greatest number from two cards. • [Name] explained how a number is made of tens and ones, and counted on in tens. • [Name] found the number the arrow showed on a number line and said how they knew.	• Bundle real things in tens (pasta, spoons) and say the tens and ones together. • Count in tens together on a number line or a hundred square.
Adding and taking away Lessons 5 to 8. We looked at adding by making a ten, jumping in tens, taking away tens and ones, and using = as a balance.	• [Name] added by making a ten and used a jump of ten on a number line. • [Name] took away tens and ones and explained each step. • [Name] used the equals sign as a balance and found the missing number.	• Use counters and a number line, with small steps (add 10, take away 10). • Play balance: 8 + 4 = 6 + what? Check with counters.
Measuring length and solving stories Lessons 9 to 10. We looked at drawing and reading lengths in centimetres with a ruler, and reading a story twice and writing one step at a time.	• [Name] used a ruler from the 0 mark and drew a line of the right length. • [Name] read a story twice and wrote one number sentence for each step. • [Name] worked out a longer length from a line already drawn.	• Measure things at home from the 0 mark. • Act out two-step stories with counters, one step at a time.

A filled example (fictional child, Mei)

Mi's Challenge Quest: Mei
In Mi's Challenge Quest, Mei read the sticks as 3 tens and 9 ones, used her ruler from the 0 mark and wrote one number sentence for each step of a story. A good next step: act out two-step stories with counters at home.

This line describes Mei's own thinking in the game. It does not compare children.

Words to avoid in the line: score, mark, out of, rank, top, below average, behind, ahead of, pass, fail, predicted, ready for. No claim about school exams, GEP or any contest, and no mention of other children. The line goes to the parent only. If the child skipped the secret cave or a gate, say nothing about it. If the child tried the secret cave, you may add: "[Name] also had a go at the secret cave."